Plale Lab Shared Glossary and Operational Definitions

Working proposal for team review

Starter version 0.1 — 10 October 2026

Status: proposed; not lab-approved. This starter offers a format and illustrative definitions for discussion. It does not claim team consensus or establish lab policy.

1 Purpose and use

A shared glossary can make the intended meaning and boundaries of a term visible. An operational definition adds the observations or decision rules needed to apply that meaning in a specified setting. Neither a concise definition nor a successful document build establishes scientific validity.

The entries below are starter proposals. Project-specific definitions, thresholds, and examples should be added through review, with public sources and a stated scope. Where evidence or a decision is missing, record that gap explicitly rather than treating it as settled.

2 Proposed entry and review convention

Each entry records the term, working definition, scope, inclusions, exclusions, operational criteria where applicable, source and source version, entry version, and status. An entry may also record a synthetic example, counterexample, related terms, and open questions.

New entries start as **proposed**. An **adopted** entry requires an explicit team decision with a date and public reference. Adoption is limited to the entry's stated scope. A merged pull request or a passing PDF build is not, on its own, a decision to adopt a definition. This review convention is itself a proposal for team consideration.

Copy `templates/definition-entry.tex` into the appropriate part of this document, replace the placeholders, and cite public sources through `references.bib`. Keep private material outside this public repository.

3 Illustrative proposed entries

3.1 Working definition

Working definition. An explicit, revisable statement of the meaning intended for a term within a stated context.

Scope. Terminology entries in this glossary.

Includes. The intended referent, relevant context, and boundaries needed to interpret use of the term.

Excludes. Claims that the meaning is universal, settled across disciplines, or already adopted by the lab.

Operational criteria. For this glossary, a candidate entry states its meaning and scope and identifies inclusions and exclusions. If a term will be used to measure or classify observations, the entry also supplies the operational criteria or explicitly marks them as pending. This is a proposed editorial check, not a scientific measurement rule.

Source and version. Original starter proposal in this repository, version 0.1, 10 October 2026; no external authority is claimed.

Entry version. 0.1.

Status. Proposed. Adoption decision: none recorded.

3.2 Operational definition

Working definition. A specification of how a concept will be observed, measured, or classified in a stated setting, including the rule used to interpret the observations.

Scope. Definitions used to support a repeatable measurement or classification procedure.

Includes. The observation unit, inputs, procedure, decision rule, and treatment of ambiguous or missing information, where relevant.

Excludes. A broad description of a concept without a procedure; a claim that a procedure alone establishes the concept's validity.

Operational criteria. A proposed procedure identifies the unit and inputs, states executable steps, specifies thresholds and units when used, and explains ambiguous and missing cases. It includes a synthetic example and counterexample when useful. Any unsettled rule is marked pending.

Source and version. Original starter proposal in this repository, version 0.1, 10 October 2026; no external authority is claimed.

Entry version. 0.1.

Status. Proposed. Adoption decision: none recorded.

3.3 Provenance

Working definition. Information about the origin and production history of an entity, including relevant activities and responsible agents.

Scope. Describing the derivation of a public document, definition, or other research object. This entry is a proposed local interpretation informed by the W3C PROV-O Recommendation [1]; it is not a claim of conformance to the full standard.

Includes. Source identifiers and versions, derivation steps, and attribution where publicly shareable.

Excludes. An unsupported origin claim; a guarantee of accuracy or trustworthiness; disclosure of restricted source material.

Operational criteria. For a glossary entry, record a public source or identify an original proposal; record the source version or date; and describe how the proposed definition was adapted. Use a source locator such as a section, DOI, or stable URL where available. Mark gaps as unknown.

Source and version. W3C, *PROV-O: The PROV Ontology*, Recommendation of 30 April 2013, Sections 1–3 [1]; entry adaptation version 0.1, 10 October 2026.

Entry version. 0.1.

Status. Proposed. Adoption decision: none recorded.

4 Questions for team review

- Which terms are most useful to define first, and for which projects?
- What decision process should establish adoption and later revision?
- Which entries need measurable operational criteria or boundary examples?

References

[1] World Wide Web Consortium. PROV-O: The PROV ontology. W3C Recommendation, 30 April 2013, 2013. https://www.w3.org/TR/2013/REC-prov-o-20130430/.